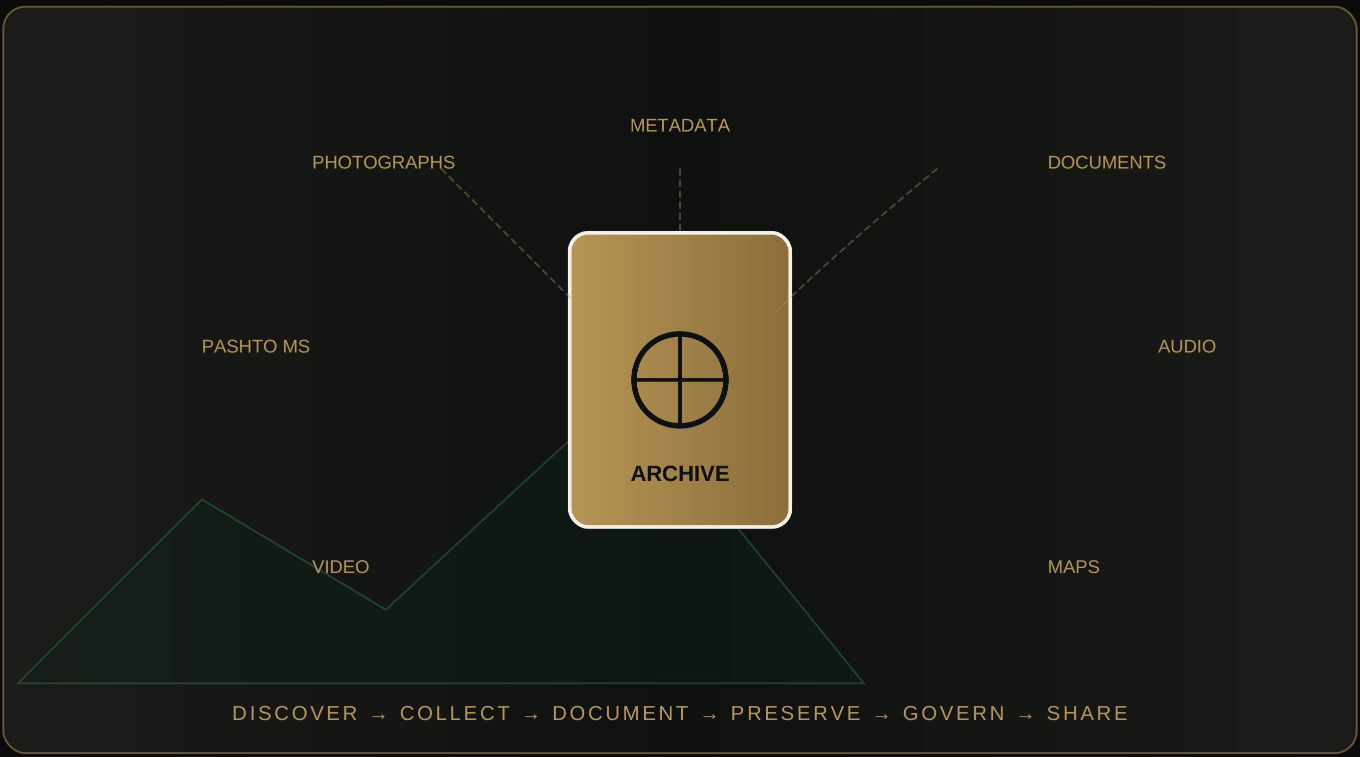
BUILDING A DIGITAL ORAKZAI ARCHIVE

"Preserving memory requires more than storage. It requires structure, context and trust."



Building a Digital Orakzai Archive: Preserving memory requires structure, context and trust.

> *"An archive begins with a simple decision: Do not let the record disappear. A photograph without a name can become anonymous. A document without context can become difficult to understand. A recording without metadata can become almost impossible to search. A family story without preservation may disappear with the person who remembered it.*
>
> *Digitization creates an opportunity. It allows fragile photographs, documents, recordings, maps and memories to be copied, described, preserved and*

> *connected. But a digital archive is more than a folder full of files. It needs structure. It needs metadata. It needs preservation. It needs verification. It needs access rules. It needs people who care for it. And most importantly, it needs trust.*
>
> *For Orakzai history, the goal should not simply be to collect as much material as possible. The goal should be to build a record that future generations can understand, question, research and continue."*

WHAT IS A DIGITAL ARCHIVE?

A digital archive is an organized system for preserving, describing, managing and providing appropriate access to digital or digitized records. It is distinct from a digital library, database, or social media page because it requires a long-term preservation strategy, comprehensive metadata, and strict governance. We follow the **3-2-1 Backup Strategy** (3 copies, 2 media types, 1 offsite) to ensure digital resilience.

Digital Archive Components: FILES + METADATA + PRESERVATION + GOVERNANCE + ACCESS

PROPOSED ORAKZAI DIGITAL ARCHIVE — ARCHITECTURE

The following categories represent a proposed structure for a comprehensive Orakzai archive. **PROPOSED ARCHITECTURE — NOT A CLAIM THAT ALL CATEGORIES CURRENTLY EXIST IN A SINGLE ORAKZAI ARCHIVE.**

- HISTORY
- ORAL HISTORY
- PHOTOGRAPHS
- DOCUMENTS
- MAPS
- LANGUAGE
- MUSIC
- POETRY
- PROVERBS
- FOOD
- CLOTHING
- HOSPITALITY
- FAMILY RECORDS
- GENEALOGIES
- MIGRATION
- DIASPORA
- EDUCATION
- RELIGIOUS LIFE
- MARKETS
- AGRICULTURE

ARCHIVAL RECOMMENDATION MATRIX

Recommendation	Classification	Standard / Best Practice	Source	Confidence
3-2-1 Backup Strategy	Preservation	Best Practice	DPC (2025)	High
Dublin Core Metadata	Description	Archival Standard	OAI-PMH Guidelines	High
Community Governance	Governance	Proposed Model	Mukurtu / CLOCKSS	High
IIIF Interoperability	Access	Archival Standard	IIIF Consortium	High

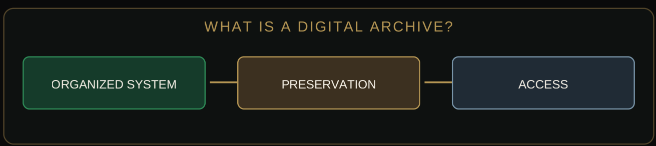
PROVENANCE AND AUTHENTICITY

Provenance means documenting where material came from and its relationship to its creator, owner or previous custodian. A useful archive documents the **Chain of Custody** (Source → Custody → Digitization → Archive). We do not claim provenance is complete when records are uncertain. Digital integrity is maintained through **Checksums** and fixity checks, though these do not prove historical authenticity by themselves.

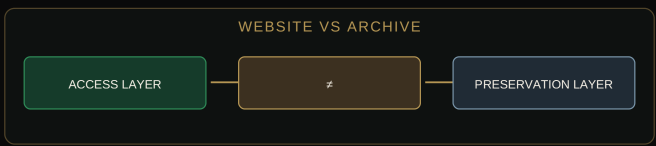
AI AND ARCHIVAL MANAGEMENT

AI may assist with OCR, speech-to-text, and metadata suggestions, but it should never manufacture missing archive records. AI-generated metadata must be labelled as machine-generated until reviewed. We do not automatically assume AI output is correct. AI-generated text is not evidence of historical truth. Human review is the final authority to ensure authenticity and prevent the fabrication of history. We do not claim that technology can independently preserve culture; evidence is limited regarding AI's ability to capture deep cultural context.

LOGIC ATLAS: BUILDING A DIGITAL ARCHIVE

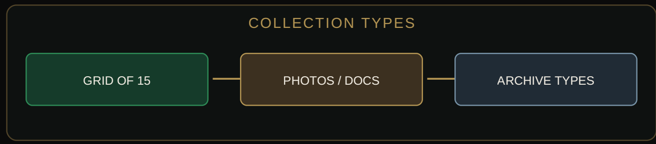


1. What is a digital archive? — archival framework.

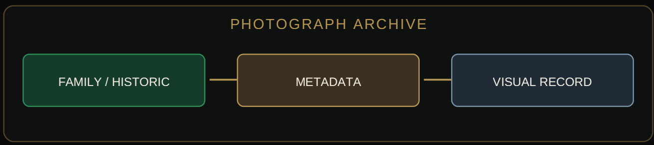


2. Website vs archive — archival framework.

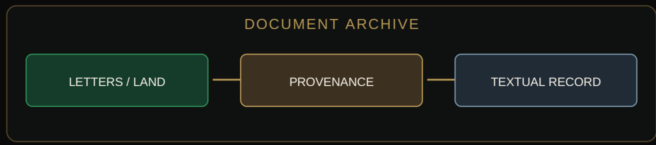
3. Proposed Orakzai archive — archival framework.



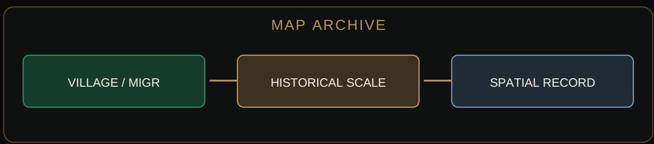
4. Collection types — archival framework.



5. Photograph archive — archival framework.

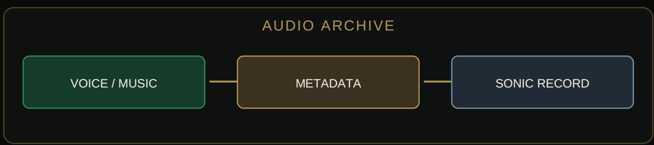


6. Document archive — archival framework.

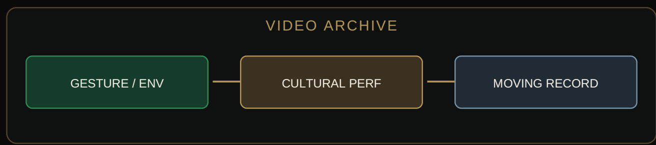


7. Map archive — archival framework.

8. Pashto manuscript — archival framework.



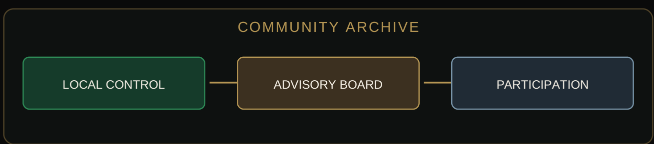
9. Audio archive — archival framework.



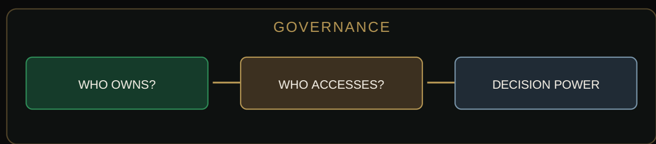
10. Video archive — archival framework.

11. Newspaper archive — archival framework.

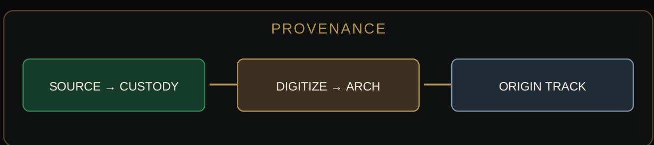
12. Family archive — archival framework.



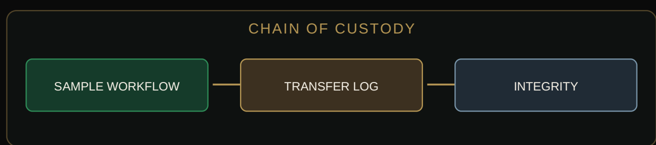
13. Community archive — archival framework.



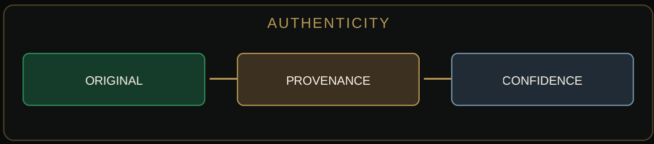
14. Governance — archival framework.



15. Provenance — archival framework.

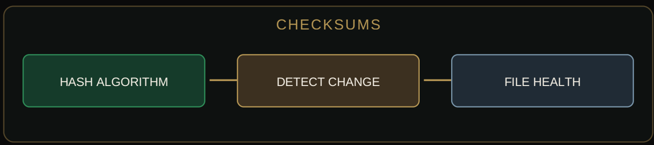


16. Chain of custody — archival framework.



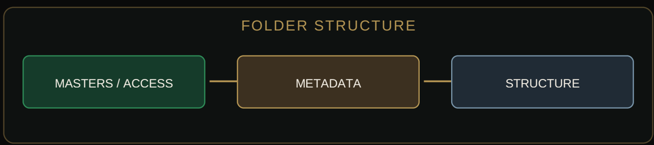
17. Authenticity — archival framework.

18. Digital integrity — archival framework.

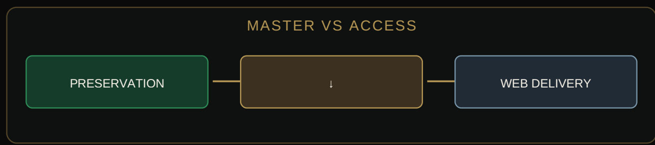


19. Checksums — archival framework.

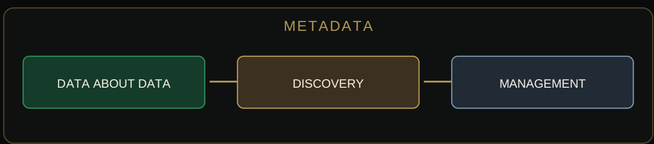
20. File naming — archival framework.



21. Folder structure — archival framework.

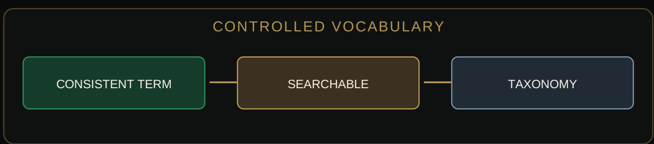


22. Master vs access — archival framework.

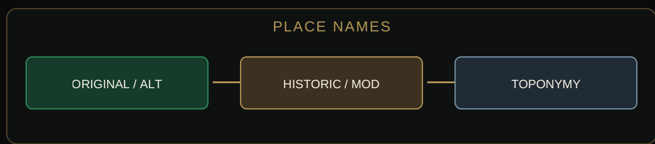


23. Metadata — archival framework.

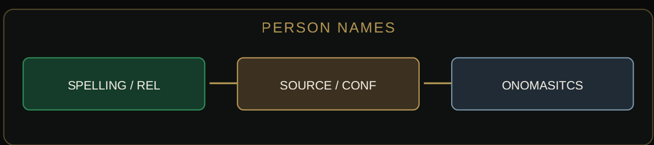
24. Metadata minimum — archival framework.



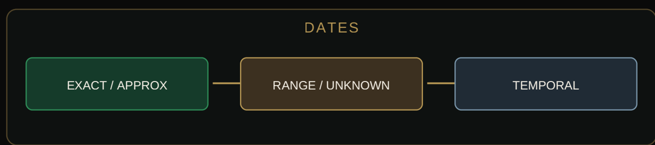
25. Controlled vocabulary — archival framework.



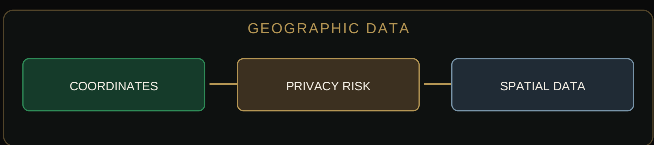
26. Place names — archival framework.



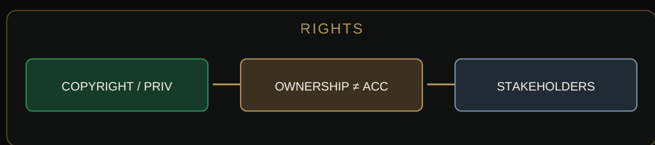
27. Person names — archival framework.



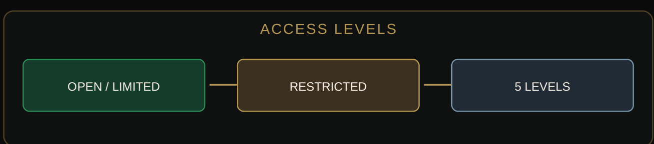
28. Dates — archival framework.

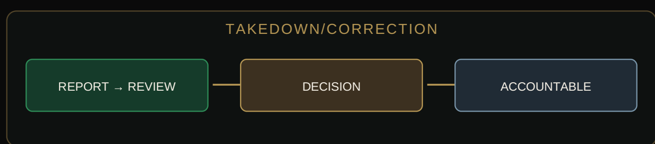


29. Geographic data — archival framework.



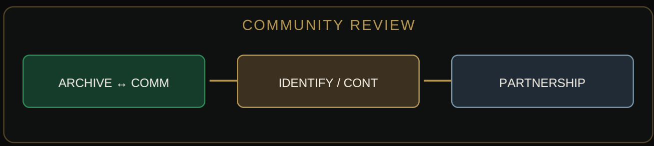
30. Rights — archival framework.



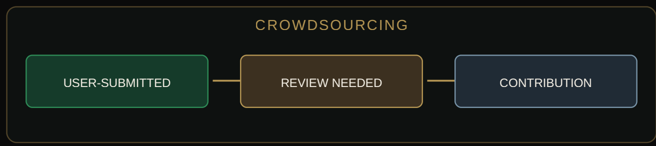


31. Access levels — archival framework.

32. Takedown/correction — archival framework.

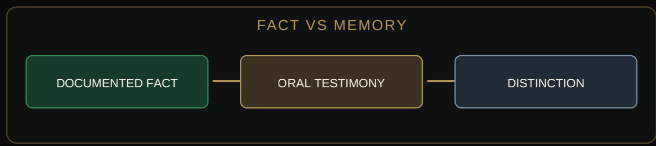


33. Community review — archival framework.

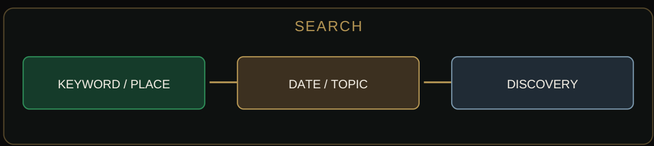


34. Crowdsourcing — archival framework.

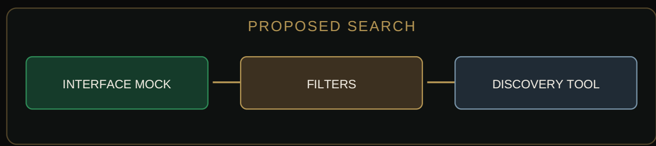
35. Evidence levels — archival framework.



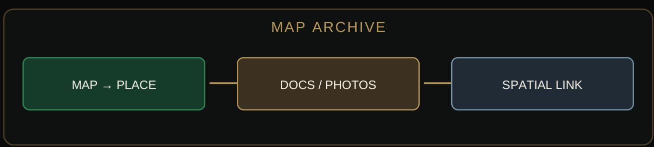
36. Fact vs memory — archival framework.



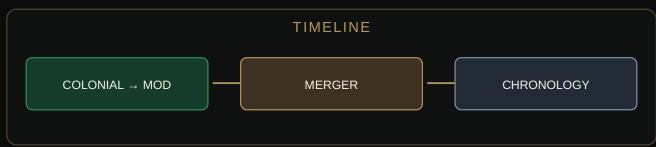
37. Search — archival framework.



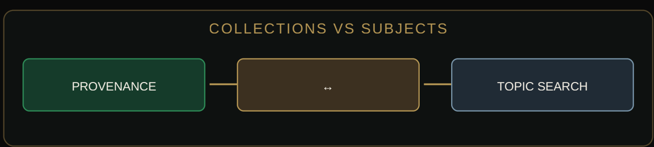
38. Proposed search — archival framework.



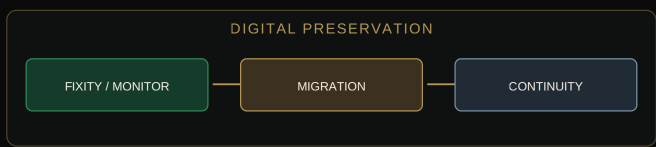
39. Map archive — archival framework.



40. Timeline — archival framework.

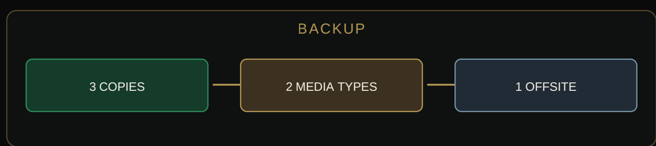


41. Collections vs subjects — archival framework.



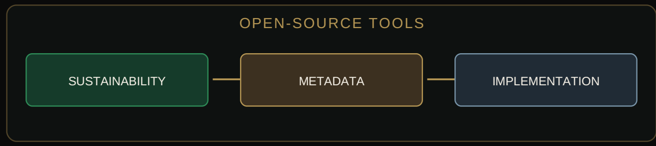
42. Digital preservation — archival framework.

43. Format obsolescence — archival framework.



44. Backup — archival framework.

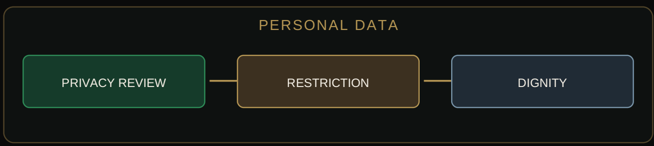
45. Cloud storage — archival framework.



46. Open-source tools — archival framework.

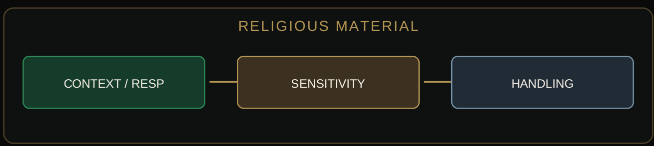
47. Security — archival framework.

48. Cybersecurity — archival framework.



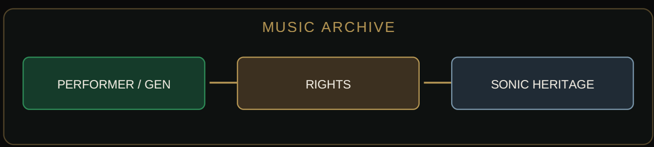
49. Personal data — archival framework.

50. Children's records — archival framework.

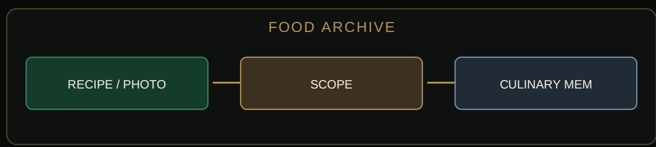


51. Religious material — archival framework.

52. Genealogy — archival framework.

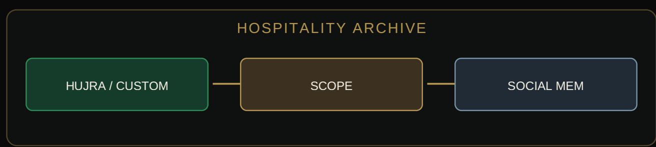


53. Music archive — archival framework.

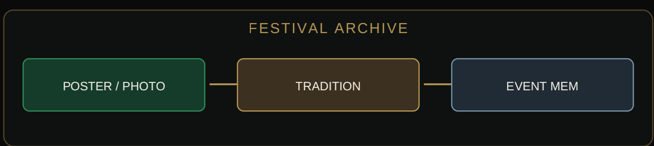


54. Food archive — archival framework.

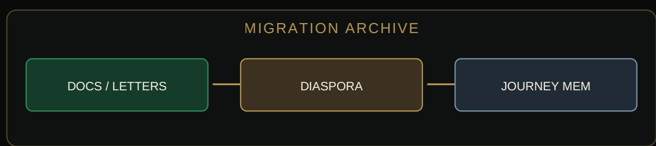
55. Clothing archive — archival framework.



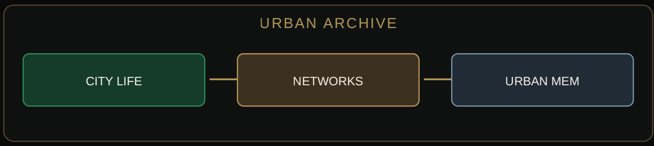
56. Hospitality archive — archival framework.



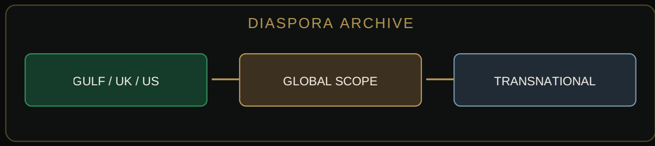
57. Festival archive — archival framework.



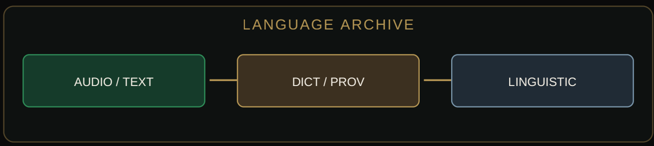
58. Migration archive — archival framework.



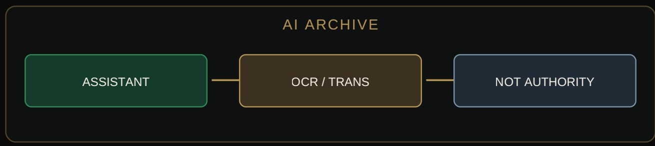
59. Urban archive — archival framework.



60. Diaspora archive — archival framework.

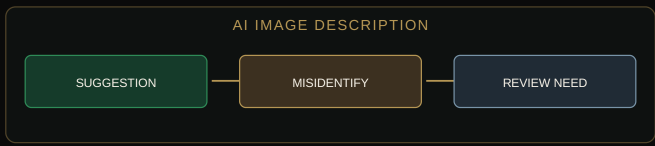


61. Language archive — archival framework.

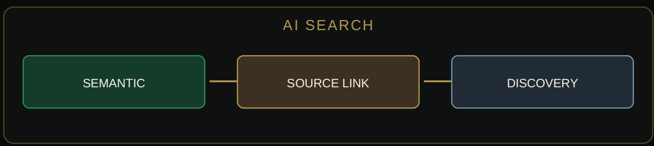


62. AI archive — archival framework.

63. AI OCR — archival framework.

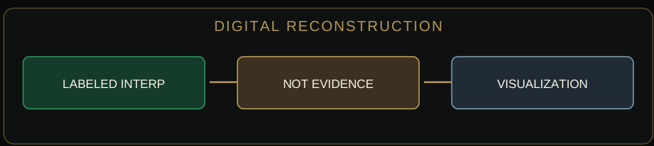


64. AI image description — archival framework.

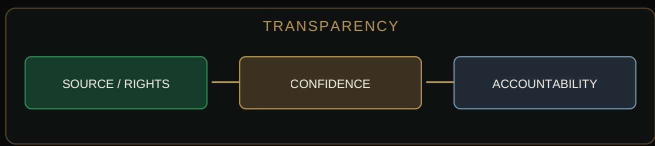


65. AI search — archival framework.

66. AI fabrication — archival framework.

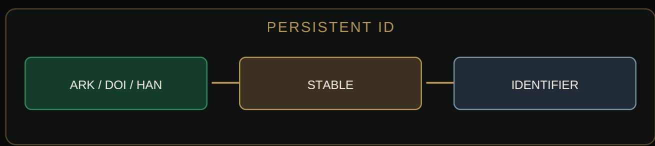


67. Digital reconstruction — archival framework.



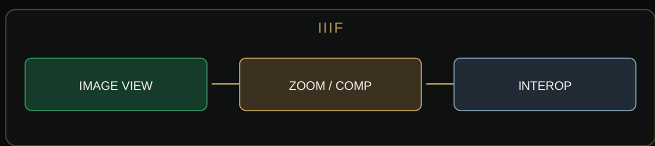
68. Transparency — archival framework.

69. Archival citation — archival framework.

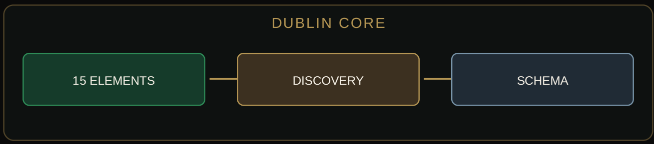


70. Persistent ID — archival framework.

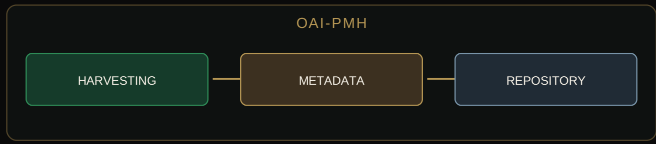
71. Interoperability — archival framework.



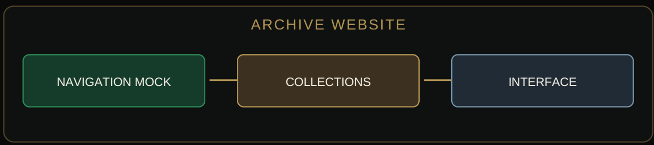
72. IIIF — archival framework.



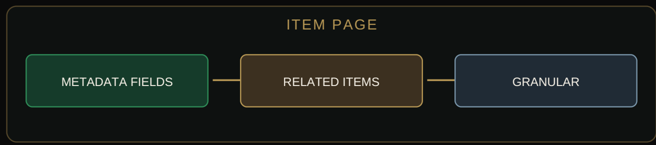
73. Dublin Core — archival framework.



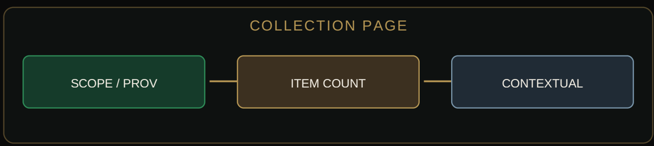
74. OAI-PMH — archival framework.



75. Archive website — archival framework.

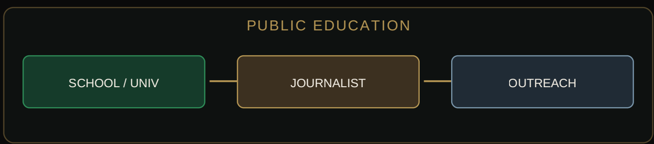


76. Item page — archival framework.

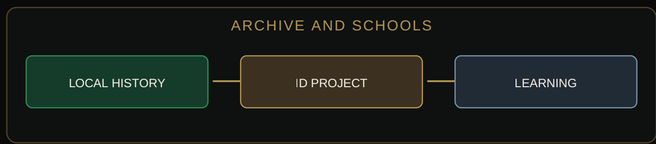


77. Collection page — archival framework.

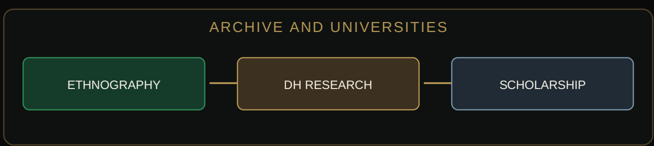
78. Researcher workspace — archival framework.



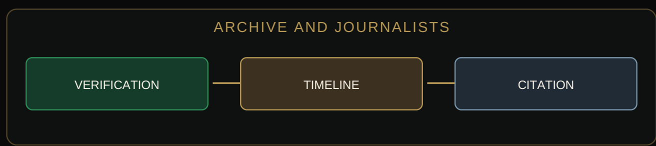
79. Public education — archival framework.



80. Archive and schools — archival framework.



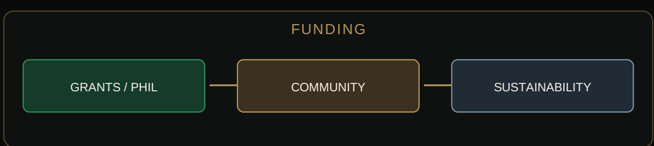
81. Archive and universities — archival framework.



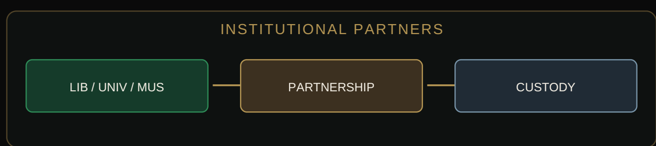
82. Archive and journalists — archival framework.

83. Archive and families — archival framework.

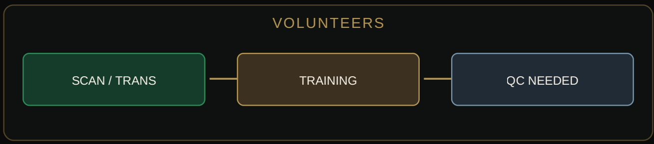
84. Future generations — archival framework.



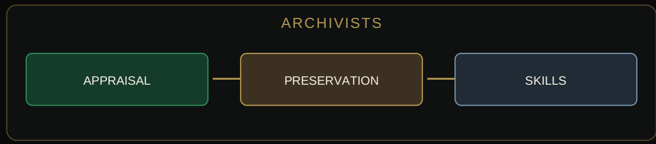
85. Funding — archival framework.



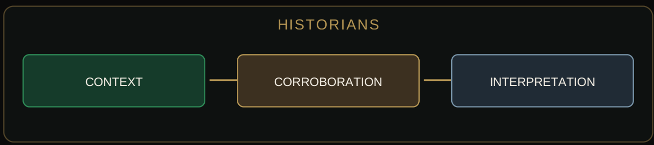
86. Institutional partners — archival framework.



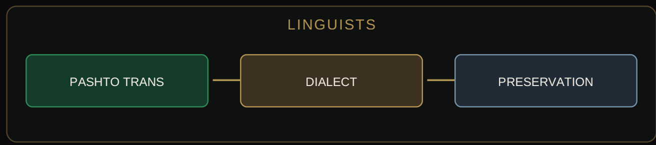
87. Volunteers — archival framework.



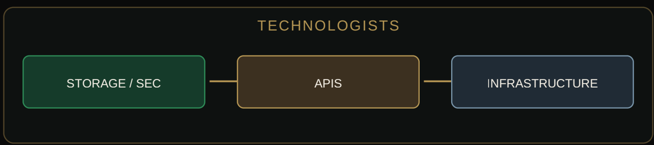
88. Archivists — archival framework.



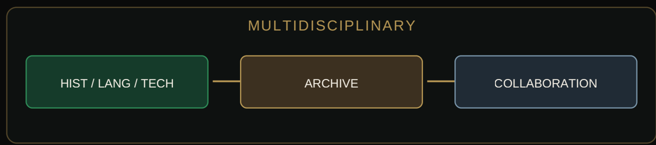
89. Historians — archival framework.



90. Linguists — archival framework.

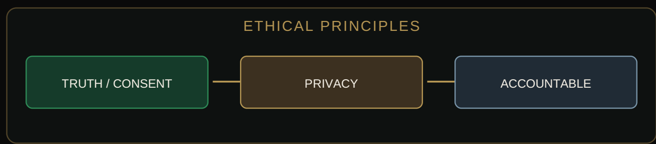


91. Technologists — archival framework.



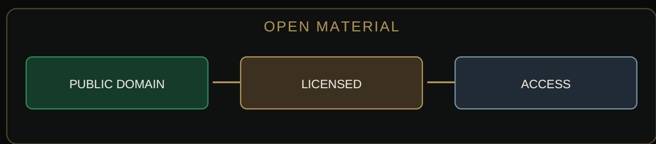
92. Multidisciplinary — archival framework.

93. Community governance — archival framework.

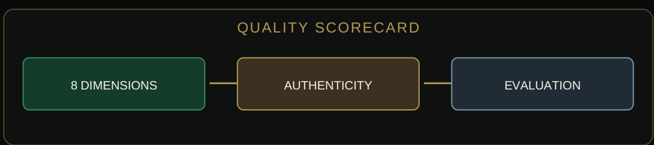


94. Ethical principles — archival framework.

95. Restricted material — archival framework.

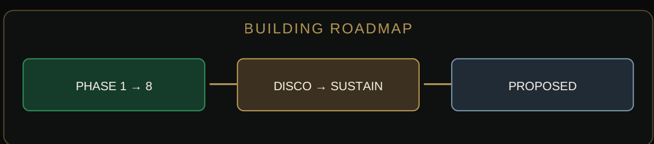


96. Open material — archival framework.

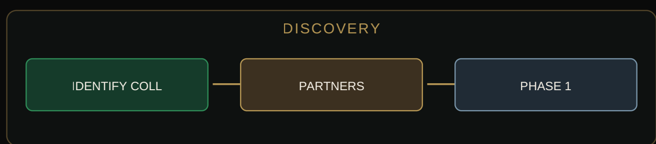


97. Quality scorecard — archival framework.

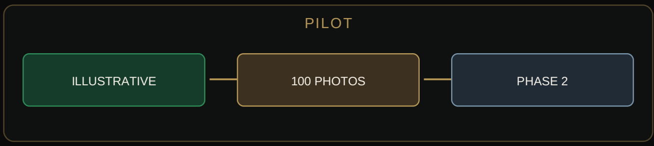
98. Archive maturity — archival framework.



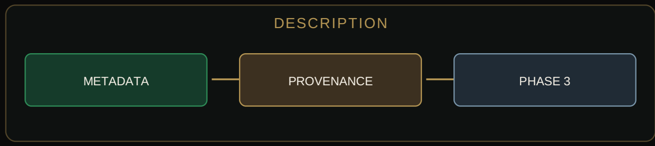
99. Building roadmap — archival framework.



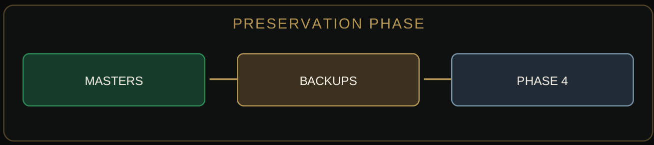
100. Discovery — archival framework.



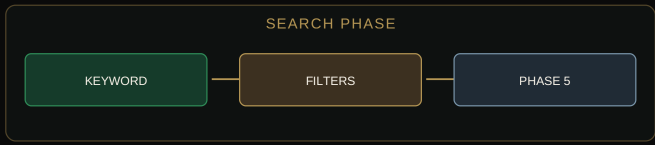
101. Pilot — archival framework.



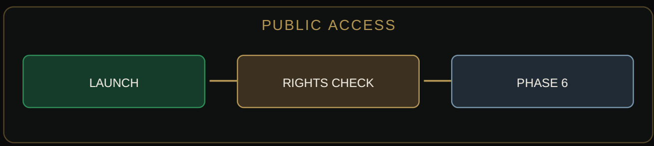
102. Description — archival framework.



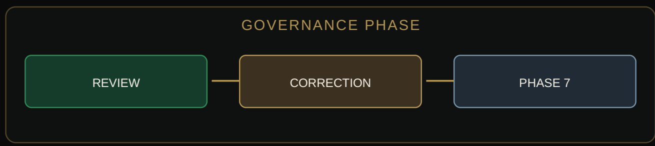
103. Preservation phase — archival framework.



104. Search phase — archival framework.



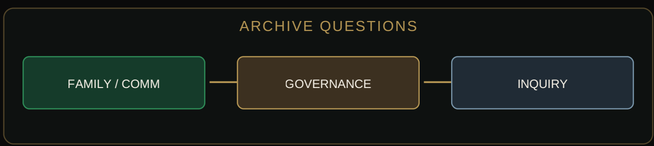
105. Public access — archival framework.



106. Governance phase — archival framework.

107. Sustainability — archival framework.

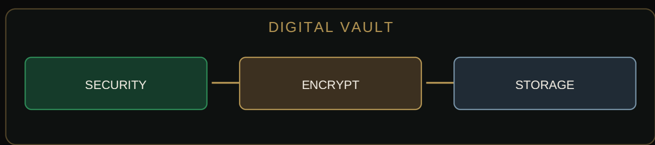
108. Research gap — archival framework.



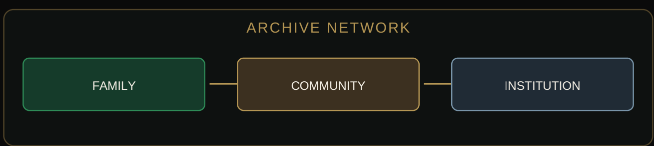
109. Archive questions — archival framework.

110. Author reflection — archival framework.

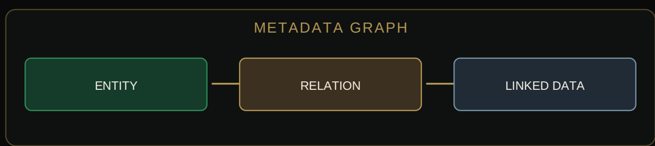
111. Final statement — archival framework.



112. Digital vault — archival framework.



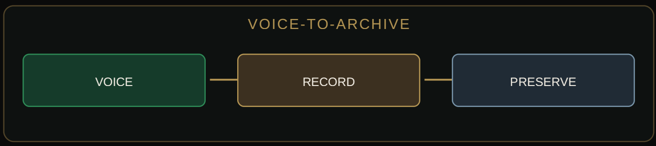
113. Archive network — archival framework.



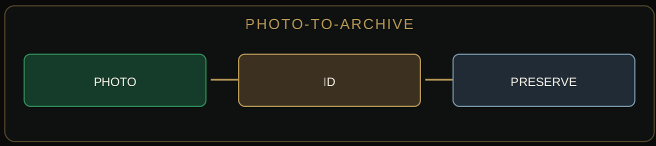
114. Metadata graph — archival framework.

115. Evidence graph — archival framework.

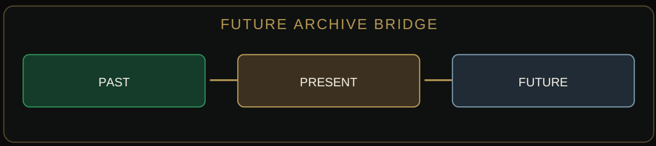
116. Family-to-archive — archival framework.



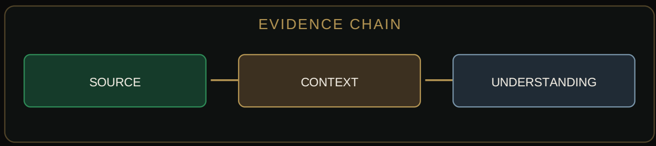
117. Voice-to-archive — archival framework.



118. Photo-to-archive — archival framework.



119. Future archive bridge — archival framework.



120. Evidence chain — archival framework.

ARCHIVE MATURITY MODEL

PROPOSED MATURITY MODEL:

- LEVEL 1 — FILE COLLECTION
- LEVEL 2 — ORGANIZED COLLECTION
- LEVEL 3 — METADATA ARCHIVE
- LEVEL 4 — PRESERVED REPOSITORY
- LEVEL 5 — INTEROPERABLE DIGITAL ARCHIVE
- LEVEL 6 — COMMUNITY-GOVERNED ARCHIVE

BUILDING ROADMAP

1. PHASE 1 — DISCOVERY: Identify existing collections and partners.
2. PHASE 2 — PILOT: Manage a small illustrative project-scoping example (e.g., 100 photos).
3. PHASE 3 — DESCRIPTION: Create metadata and document provenance.
4. PHASE 4 — PRESERVATION: Create masters, access copies, and backups.
5. PHASE 5 — SEARCH: Add keyword, place, and date indexing.
6. PHASE 6 — PUBLIC ACCESS: Launch material with clear rights status.
7. PHASE 7 — COMMUNITY GOVERNANCE: Create review and correction mechanisms.
8. PHASE 8 — SUSTAINABILITY: Plan long-term funding and succession.

ARCHIVE QUESTIONS

1. What historical materials already exist in your family?
2. Who owns them?
3. Where are they stored?
4. Are old photographs identified?
5. Are old recordings still playable?
6. Which documents require preservation?
7. Which family stories remain undocumented?
8. Which village histories need recording?
9. Which Pashto materials need digitization?
10. Which materials should remain private?

AUTHOR'S REFLECTION

"I have come to understand that preservation is not simply about saving the past. It is about creating a bridge between generations. A photograph may show a face, but an archive can help identify the person. A document may record a decision, but metadata can explain where it came from. A recording may preserve a voice, but a transcript can make that voice searchable. A map may show a place, but connected oral histories can reveal what that place meant to the people who lived there.

That is why I believe an Orakzai digital archive should be built with both technology and humility. Technology can store enormous amounts of information. It cannot decide what a memory means. It cannot determine whether a story is true simply because it is repeated. It cannot replace the people whose lives created the record.

The archive of the future should therefore be more than a database. It should be a carefully governed memory system — one that preserves evidence, respects people, records uncertainty and gives future generations the tools to ask better questions. If we build it responsibly, the archive will not merely preserve where we came from. It will help future generations understand who we became."

AN ARCHIVE IS NOT A WAREHOUSE FOR THE PAST.
IT IS A BRIDGE TO THE FUTURE.

RESEARCH SOURCES & FOOTNOTES

1. Digital Preservation Coalition (DPC), *Digital Preservation Handbook*, 2025.
2. UNESCO, *Guidelines for the Selection of Digital Heritage for Long-Term Preservation*, 2024.

3. UI Libraries / Mukurtu, *The Ethics of Open Access Digital Archives*, 2018.
4. Library of Congress, *Sustainability of Digital Formats*, 2024.
5. National Archives (NARA), *Technical Guidelines for Digitizing Archival Materials*, 2023.